

Council Meeting
March 21, 2019
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Thursday, March 21, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager

CITIZEN’S FORUM

None

OLD BUSINESS

Discussion of Hiring Process for City Manger

Mr. Damren thanked John MacLean for the handout of the “City of Lebanon City Manager Search Process.” Mr. Damren went on to explain that Lebanon used a hybrid approach. They established a Governance Committee, which is the public face. We have already done step 2, which is the request of RFP’s. He feels we should use this approach; stating the company does not have to be MRI but by using a company they are doing the leg work and we get access to their search tools. He also noted that the council developed a successful profile only two years ago, and that would still be usable.

Mr. Damren said he spoke with Primex, and said they provide a service that has each councilor fill out a survey to get a collective picture of what the council is looking for in a city manager.

Mr. Zullo asked what the cost for this would be, did Lebanon give us a figure?

Mr. MacLean stated Lebanon's cost was around \$14,000.

Mr. MacLean said this is hard because I work for MRI and I am not here to tell you to hire MRI but I feel it would be in your best interest to hire a company that does this. If you did go with MRI I would be able to assist with the process which would lower the cost.

Mr. Damren felt that none of the received proposals were what we were looking for.

Ms. Kier said there is at least one proposal that she thought was good, and thinks this is weird that we received 4 proposals and we are now talking about a company that didn't even respond to our RFQ.

Mr. Koloski would like to discuss GovHR stating that he likes the hybrid approach but that the ultimate decision for him will be based on how much this will cost the city.

Mr. Stone suggested we go thru the proposals we did receive and weed them out.

- The LMC Group from New Hampshire

Discussion on this group were that most of their experience is in the healthcare field and they have not placed a city manager.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to remove The LMC Group from consideration.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-1 with Mr. Pope voting no

- ROI Search Group from Illinois

Also has no government experience and did not follow the instructions of the RFQ.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Stone to remove ROI Search Group from consideration.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0

- David Gomez and Associates from Indiana

He is persistent and also has no city government experience.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to remove David Gomez and Associates from consideration.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0

Ms. Kier believes GovHR is the best proposal we received, they have done Massachusetts and have all Municipal experience. They have done 51 city manager placements. She agrees it comes down to cost but does really like their proposals.

Mr. Koloski stated he also likes GovHR and is interested in what their fee is.

Ms. Lessard said she had a local businessman call her and ask why we can't form a city board to lead the search.

Mr. Pope wondered if the person that called Ms. Lessard would be willing to present a proposal to the council; he has reservations but is willing to listen.

Mr. MacLean advised the council that while they are concerned with the cost they must remember you cannot afford to make a mistake because that will cost you more in the long run.

Mr. Pope said the last time the range was \$14,000-\$27,000.

With all councilors in agreement the Fee proposal from GovHR was opened and read by Mr. Damren.

Full Scope Recruitment = \$20,000*

Limited Scope Recruitment = \$17,000*

*This fee does not include travel and accommodations for candidates interviewed.

Ms. Kier stated that price is less than she thought it was going to be and for small difference we should go with the full scope

Mr. O'Hearne felt it should be opened up to local and internal first to see if anyone is qualified, by local meaning New England area. As the last 2 managers have come from the New England area.

Ms. Kier stated if we went with a firm it does not preclude anyone from applying but it gives us the benefit of experience with filling the position.

Mr. Zullo said we have a proposal from MRI, maybe we should send this hybrid approach to GovHR for them to give us a price.

Mr. Koloski felt that we need to have a firm that would get the national reach, locals are still able to apply. This is bigger than would we can handle.

Mayor Lovett asked by show of hands who was interested in hiring a firm, all voted yes except Mr. O'Hearne and Mr. Stone.

Both Ms. Kier & Mr. Koloski said they have nothing against MRI but we did not receive a proposal from them and they have both heard from citizens that were unhappy with the process last time.

Mr. Damren if we go with MRI we have a secret weapon in Mr. MacLean helping with the process.

Mr. Stone agreed with Ms. Kier & Mr. Koloski with regards to MRI.

Mr. Maclean said the MRI proposal came about from a conversation with the Mayor Lovett and Assistant Mayor, because the Lebanon search was so successful.

Mr. Pope would like to hear from MRI regarding price and would like to give GovHR a chance to give price on the hybrid approach so that we are comparing apples to apples.

Joe Osgood, Ward 1 said he is concerned with the six figures that keep get mentioned regarding the old manager. I think the problem is with the contract. The council needs to read the contract before hiring the next manager.

Mr. MacLean asked if it would help if the they had a conference call with GovHR.

A motion was made by Ms. Keir seconded by Mr. Pope to have Mr. Damren contact GovHR to schedule a conference call at the next meeting, March 26th.

Mr. LaCasse, Ward 2 made a suggestion of only moving the meeting to a future date so you do not have to re-notice it.

Mayor Lovett continued this meeting to March 26, 2019 at 6:30pm.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mr. Zullo asked to have an update on 139 Main St regarding the barriers.

Mr. MacLean stated they have moved the barriers back so it is back to two lane traffic. The city has been working with the owner of the adjacent property. We have to be careful because the City does not own the building. We have an order to allow us to demolish the building but the one bid that was received for demolish was rejected because there was nothing for work to shore up the adjacent building.

Mayor Lovett state the next regular meeting will be March 27th at 6:00pm. Early start is for non-public regarding union negotiations.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to recess the meeting until March 26, 2019 at 6:30pm.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn R. Melcher
City Clerk